

Monica Vasco

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🌐 <https://sites.google.com/view/monicavasco>

🔍 **Research interests:** Experimental economics, behavioral economics, social networks, economics of education, lab-in-the-field experiments



Education

- Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2026 **Postdoc**, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA.
- Dec. 2021 – Jul. 2024 **Ph.D Data Science**, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Title: *Decision-making and networks among adolescents*
Pre-doctoral stay (2023) at Essex University, UK
- Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2022 **MSc. Economics: Empirical Applications and Policies**, Basque Country University, Bilbao, Spain. Title: *School bullying and social networks*.
- Oct. 2020 – Jul. 2021 **MRes Social Sciences Methods** Loyola Andalucía University, Sevilla, Spain.
Title: *Cognitive abilities, risk-taking and inconsistent choices among teenagers*.
- Sep. 2015 – Jun. 2020 **B.A. Business Administration** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Erasmus (2018) at Derby University, UK
- B.A. Law** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.

Employment History

- Jun. 2025 – Jun. 2026 **Project Specialist**
Los Angeles Behavioral Economics Laboratory, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
- Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025 **Research Assistant**
Los Angeles Behavioral Economics Laboratory, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
- Dec. 2021 – Sep. 2024 **Research Assistant**
Loyola Behavioural Lab, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
- Jan. 2021 – Jun. 2021 **Internship**
Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
- Jan. 2020 – Jun. 2020 **Internship**
Loyola Behavioural Lab, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain

Teaching

- 23/24 **Econometrics** (Instructor of Record, taught in English). Business Administration Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- 22/23 **Growth and Development Economics** (Instructor of Record, taught in Spanish). International Relations Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.

Research Publications

Published papers

- 1 Vasco, M., Alfonso, A., Arenas, A., Cabrales, A., Cuesta, J. A., Espín, A. M., ... Jorrat, D. et al. (2025). Economic preferences and cognitive abilities among teenagers in Spain. *Scientific Data*, 12(1), 7.
- 2 Vasco, M., & Francisco, M. J. V.-D. (2025). Holt-laury as a gumball machine. *PloS one*, 20(4), e0320576.
- 3 Alfonso, A., Brañas-Garza, P., Jorrat, D., Lomas, P., Prissé, B., Vasco, M., & Vázquez-De Francisco, M. J. (2023). The adventure of running experiments with teenagers. *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, 102048. [doi:10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048)

Working papers

- 1 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025b). Learning and information transfer: Evidence from an intuitive physics task.
- 2 Brañas-Garza, P., Cabrales, A., Kovářík, J., & Vasco, M. (2024). Predictors of bullying behavior and victimization at school: A network approach. *Rej.&R in American Economic Journal: Economic Policy* Available at SSRN 4912811.

Work in progress

- 1 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., & Vasco, M. (2026). *Behavioral responses to contagion risk in dynamic network games*.
- 2 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025a). *How adolescents coordinate dynamically in network games*.
- 3 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025c). *Networked decision-making and social learning in children*.
- 4 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025d). *The microfoundations of herding behavior: Learning, signals, and connectivity in children's networks*.
- 5 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., & Vasco, M. (2025a). *Friendship, enmity, and in-between: Dimensions of social relationships across development*.
- 6 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J., & Vasco, M. (2025b). *Measuring theory of mind in children and adolescents*.
- 7 Brañas-Garza, P., Kovářík, J., Mengel, F., & Vasco, M. (2024). *Perception of social network relationships among adolescents*.

Presentations and research seminars

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| Jul. 2026 | ■ Borchard Colloquium, Château de la Bretesche, Missillac, France |
| Jun. 2026 | ■ WEAI 101st Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado, USA |
| Apr. 2026 | ■ 11th annual conference on Network Science in Economics, Miami, Florida, USA |
| Oct. 2025 | ■ Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Los Angeles, California, USA |
| | ■ Economics Science Association (ESA), Tucson, Arizona, USA |
| Jan. 2025 | ■ Experimental Economics Conference, Bogotá, Colombia |
| Oct. 2024 | ■ Economics Science Association (ESA), Columbus, Ohio, USA |
| Sep. 2024 | ■ Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Pasadena, California, USA |
| Feb. 2024 | ■ Southern Europe Experimental Team's Meeting (SEET), Málaga, Spain |
| Sep. 2023 | ■ Economics Science Association (ESA), Exeter University, Exeter, UK |

Presentations and research seminars (continued)

Jun. 2023	■	IAREP-SABE 47th International Conference, Université Côte d'Azur, Nice, France
Jan. 2023	■	Graduate Student Workshop in Experimental Economics, Chapman University, USA
Jun. 2022	■	Conference on Human Capital Investments, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
Jun. 2021	■	e3c LATAM PhD Workshop, Universitat Illes Balears, Balearic Islands, Spain

Funding

Dec. 2021 – Nov. 2025	■	FPU , PhD grant (FPU20/05846) <i>Spanish Ministry of Universities</i>
Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2025	■	Decisions, Education, Networks and Teenagers , (PID2021-126892NB-I00) <i>Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation</i> IPs: Pablo Brañas and Antonio Cabrales

Skills

Languages	■	English (fluent), Spanish (native)
Software	■	R (RStudio), Stata, oTree, Qualtrics, Matlab, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Knime, Weka
Quantitative Methods	■	Econometrics, Experimental Design, Social Network Analysis, Causal Inference, Survey Design, Lab-in-the-Field Experiments
Research & Project Management	■	Coordination of field experiments, data collection management, IRB compliance, participant recruitment and incentives, collaboration with schools and research teams

References

Pablo Brañas (advisor)

Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad Loyola Andalucía
✉ branasgarza@gmail.com

Antonio Cabrales

Professor of Economics (Research Chair)
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
✉ antonio.cabrales@uc3m.es

Jaromír Kovářík (co-advisor)

Associate Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad del País Vasco
✉ jaromir.kovarik@ehu.es

Isabelle Brocas

Professor of Economics
University of Southern California
✉ brocas@usc.edu